

Winning With Rest

Let us begin again with Romans 8:26.

Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities: for we know not what we should pray for as we ought: but the Spirit itself maketh intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered.

And he that searcheth the hearts knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit, because he maketh intercession for the saints according to the will of God.

And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose.

We got into a study somewhat on the Godhead last night, and I do not mind telling you I had a good time. From John 1:1 we found out that in the beginning, before anything had a beginning, was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. We studied who Jesus was before He was manifested as the Son of God whom you and I have come to know and love. We studied who He was in eternity past as the Logos, and who He is now.

We also began to study again the role of the Holy Spirit in redemption, because He is the One who has been sent to indwell us. To sell out to Jesus is to sell out to the Holy Spirit, because He is the One who reveals Jesus. So we were studying more and more of His work in our lives, particularly to lead us out of everything Jesus said we are free from and into everything He said we are.

In that twenty-sixth verse, he says, "Likewise the Spirit helpeth our infirmities." The simple fact that he said "our infirmities" means that whatever these infirmities are, they are things the Holy Spirit has been sent to help.

If the Holy Spirit has been sent to help my infirmities, I want to know what those infirmities are. If it takes the Holy Spirit to help them, then they must be the things that stop me. That is worth revealing.

That is what we are going to be on for quite a while. I will say this as we begin to dive in: the farther I get away from my infirmities, the more dominant I get into peace.

I keep going back over this because the Lord keeps bringing it up. The thing to keep looking for is the peace. I cannot get away from it because we probably have not had enough of it.

When I entered into the last seeking time, I began to understand more about impasses. If you had asked me three or four years ago, "Brother Roberson, are you walking in peace?" I would have said yes, because peace is relative. Peace is always comparable.

If you ask me now about two or three years ago, I would say, "My God, half the time I was in turmoil." But I would have said then that I was in peace because I was able to handle everything. It is as I grow farther and farther from the infirmity He has been sent to help, and closer and closer into Jesus, that I see what peace really is.

From the day I was born again, filled with the Holy Ghost, and understood what a call was, I have been consumed. The day the Holy Spirit came on me in a fire-like manner, my wife and I were praying late. My hands were raised, she was laying hands on me, and she said, "God, I do not even speak with tongues because I cannot speak English."

My hands heated up, then my elbows, and I fell down under the power. When I hit the floor, it knocked the wind out of me, and when the breath came out, it came out in the most fluent language.

I do not talk a lot about that, because people tend to look for some special experience when receiving the Holy Spirit. You simply receive Him. He starts talking. There does not have to be any dramatics or emotionalism. All of a sudden your mouth wants to speak this language, and that is it. It is nice when the whole building goes out under the power and cannot get up for three days, but it is not necessary.

When I went down under the power, I immediately retreated into the Spirit. I did not even know what it was. I felt like I was at the end of a long tunnel, lost in the Spirit. I could hear somebody speaking all these languages, and then I realized, as I started coming out of it, that it was me. It sounded like German for a while, then Japanese. My hands were tingling, my face went numb, and my body went numb.

When I came out of it, He said, "I have called you. My call is on you."

My wife had a vision. She saw mountains of people disappearing, and a giant hand moving across a crowd. People whose faces had been eaten away with leprosy had their faces restored as that hand passed over them.

For fifteen years, I do not know if I self-induced some kind of hallucination, but the hunger was so strong that when I got lost praying in the Holy Ghost, some vision would come to me. I would see crowds of people coming to God by the thousands, and not just in foreign countries. He specifically said, "I have called you to America." That is why He gave me a teaching ministry. He has also given us Japan. Japan has never had a major revival, and He has given us Japan.

In the last five years, I got so hungry that I began launching into fastings and prayings. That is when I came to the revelation of what an impasse was: how He deals with the flesh, how He reveals things putting a ceiling on your life, how He deals with spiritual unbelief, and how He gives you understanding so you can walk away from it.

I thought the qualification would be Jesus walking into the room and saying, "Get up. This is it. I am going to judge you, and no disease will ever stand in your presence again." I kept waiting for Him to come in. He never came. I thought, "How about an angel? A bolt of lightning?"

When I came through the last impasse, I came out feeling different from any feeling I had ever had in my life. Something had settled down on the inside of me. To try to talk about it was strange, because I had never experienced anything like it.

Jesus began to minister to me. He said, "This is what you should have been looking for. Here is your qualification. I am putting this foundation of peace in you, so that hell can pour out everything it has and it will not stop you. It cannot stop you. You have nothing to be devoured with."

He said, "It is a piece of steel on the inside of you. You will not have to accept things the way they are, because you can change them."

He began to qualify me with this peace, which I had not walked in before. I keep talking about it because it is the newest thing that has ever happened to me, and the strongest and sweetest thing in fifteen years.

You have heard of preachers burning out. I am burning in. You burn out because you take the care. Lester Sumrall said that what killed John G. Lake in Spokane with the healing center was not hard work. They said he ministered day and night until he became fatigued and exhausted. But Lester Sumrall said hard work never killed him; carrying the care did. He ought to know.

As part of walking out of this infirmity, I used to think cleansing meant getting rid of drinking, smoking, chewing, and all those things. But those are byproducts. They are fruit of something greater that needs to be dealt with.

Care is just care-fruit growing on a tree. The greater problem is the root.

He began to deal with me about these things. Part of walking out of the infirmities the Holy Spirit has been sent to help is walking out of care, pressure, and infirmity. It is through the Spirit that you mortify the deeds of the body.

When we start talking about taking no care, my friend, it is a wonderful place. The Holy Spirit has been given to you to take you there. You know you are being qualified for revival, intercession, and power like you have never walked in before when you begin qualifying in that peace.

At times in my life I had attained to a little portion of it, but never anything that moved into me and gave me steel to know I was going to make it. The times I attained degrees of peace were particularly when I spent long amounts of time praying in the Holy Ghost simply for personal edification.

In those days I knew very little about the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit, because they hardly ever came on me. But the one I could operate in continually was tongues for personal edification.

When I had a meeting that night within fifty miles of our home, I would go out to a dry riverbed in Oregon, near Oakridge by the Willamette River. I remember the little green rocks. I would spread a blanket, lie down, and start praying in tongues. Sometimes I would pray there for about an hour,

and things would start to get quiet. My mind would begin quieting down.

Then my body would get bored because I did not know what to do with it. Your mind is something else. It has its own energy. Just because you tell it to stop does not mean it will. It is like inertia. Once it gets rolling, it has its own momentum. The best you can hope for at first is to guide it: "No, you are not thinking about that. Come back over here."

When I first started praying, nobody in my part of the country knew much about it. There was no one to teach me. I continually tried to organize my mind by saying, "I cast you down, imagination," and I tried to fill it with the Word. I would think, "My God supplies all my need according to His riches in glory," and half an hour later I would realize I had been thinking about something else for fifteen minutes and had forgotten the verse.

I went through those wars, just like you have.

When it got bad, I would get up after about an hour and walk around, picking out little green rocks and kicking them. Another hour would pass. I would go back and lie on the blanket and keep praying. My mind kept wandering, and I could not control it, so I tried to direct what it would think about.

In the course of time, I do not remember how many months it took, but I came to a place of peace. I noticed I started remembering things I had forgotten twenty years before: old streets, people. These things started coming back to me, and I thought, "This is strange."

Once, while preparing for a meeting, I was listening to a Kenneth Copeland tape, watching myself on television, praying in the Holy Ghost, and meditating a whole other message for that night's service out of the Word of God, all at the same time. I noticed that the calmer I got, the more ability seemed to wake up in my mind.

Then the Lord started teaching me about oppression.

Have you ever had a policeman stop you?

"Your driver's license, please. What is your name?"

"God, I knew it this morning."

That is what pressure does, even if you are under it only for a moment, much less living under ungodly pressure for a long time. It begins affecting your mind. You start getting pressured, foggy, and worn down.

It is strange. A man can swing a sledgehammer sixteen hours a day and come home saying, "Come on, kids, let us go bowling." But another man sits in an easy chair worrying about the job he will not go out and get. He is so full of care and worry by the end of the day that he is exhausted and can only tell his kids to be quiet.

Doctors can trace a high percentage of diseases and things that go wrong in the body back to care. Why do you want to carry it when He has given you the Holy Ghost?

I like the story of a woman who won a beauty contest. At the moment of joy, they captured and analyzed her tears. They contained healing agents, chemical substances that promoted healing in the human body.

One man, whom the doctor said was going to die of cancer, rented a whole bunch of comedy films and laughed his way out of it.

Another man lost his wife, and at the most grief-stricken moment, they captured his tears and found a chemical substance that actually promoted the image that was in him, which was death. He was grieving himself to death, and his body was actually dying on him.

Care is a strange thing.

I once watched a special about a tribe in Turkey while flying overseas for a meeting. The premier of Russia came to a woman's birthday party because they had traced her back approximately 130 years, and this woman was doing a Russian dance at 130 years old. A team of doctors from the United States went there because people in that village were living to be a hundred years old and still chopping wood, hauling it back, and bathing in ice-cold streams.

The doctors wanted to know why they lived so long. It was not because they were a high mountain tribe grinding their own food and eating only organically raised gardens. They were opening cans. The woman who was 130 drank her glass of vodka and chewed tobacco. We do not advocate that, but it happened.

After studying them for months, the doctors could only come to one conclusion. The whole time they were there, they claimed they never heard a cross word between children and grandparents, husbands and wives. The village seemed to move at a quiet, calm, slow rate. Nobody got excited about anything. Nobody seemed to carry care. They wandered around, did their jobs, lived, and loved.

There was such peace there that the doctors examined their vascular systems and hearts. The only reason they could figure for these people living so long was that somehow they had settled into a pace of life without care, and their bodies were affected by it.

I found out that the longer I freed my mind from oppression, pressure, and care, the more it began to return to itself.

Let me tell you something about your capabilities when you learn how to operate out of the spirit. I suppose He is leading this way for a reason, to let you know what is in store for you. It is wonderful.

Think about the capacity of the first man, Adam. Not only did he name all the animals, but he retained those names in his memory centuries later. Your spirit has the capacity to receive and store up to a million bits of information per second. That is why God communicates with your spirit.

God will send something over to your spirit and turn it loose like a computer chip releasing its program. All of a sudden you say, "My God, I know everything. I just do not know how I know it." Sometimes it takes the servant, the mind, three months to decipher what came across to your spirit in thirty seconds.

In half a second you can receive enough information to save your whole business, and then it may take three days for your secretary to put it on paper and get it to the business. You say, "How did I get it?" You do not know. It exploded in your spirit, and you understood hours of material on how to reorganize everything.

The Holy Spirit communicated with your spirit because your spirit is capable of receiving His communication.

Adam operated out of his spirit. His mind was only a servant.

Once in a while you get a person like Einstein with exceptional gray matter, and he figures theories, mathematical formulas, relativity, and infinity. He is figuring theories on things we did not even know were there. Someone else receives a gift in music, beauty, or some other ability. But Adam was perfect: spirit, soul, and body. When he fell, degeneration began to set in.

Thank God, the Holy Spirit has been sent to help our infirmities, our weaknesses, and the limitations imposed on us by this flesh while it waits for glorification.

When a man learns to operate out of his spirit, things begin to change. The longer I remained in peace while praying in tongues, the more my mind began to wake up.

When I tried to guide my mind, I had problems because it had its own energy. It wanted to think about what it wanted to think about. Wrong thoughts would come, and I would cast them down. Then my mind would start exploring some vast problem plaguing the ministry, and I would cast that down too.

"I do not receive that. Get away from me, unbelief. I will not receive the care."

I would go back to praying in tongues. Pretty soon the whole problem would begin feeding through me: "You do not have any income coming in. No meetings for two weeks. Nobody wants you to preach. The cupboards are almost empty. What are you going to do?"

The problem would try to feed in, and I would rebuke it and start praying in tongues again.

But when I attained a certain amount of peace, I noticed that the problem was not really bothering me. I used to spend all my energy getting rid of it. That was when I thought the fight with care was an external thing.

"Take care, Brother Roberson."

"Do not tell me to take care. I do not receive it."

That paints a picture of a man full of care and fear.

After I entered into a relative amount of peace, I realized the problem was not really bothering me. My mind began to explore problems, and because it was not getting into care, I let it go.

My spirit would be praying, and my mind would look at the problem: "Here is this deadline. Here is this wall. If you do not get past this, this will not happen. If you do not sell that old truck, you will not get an economy car to come to the meetings."

All these impasses would come while I was praying and entering further into edification.

For with stammering lips and another tongue will he speak to this people.

To whom he said, This is the rest wherewith ye may cause the weary to rest; and this is the refreshing.

After my mind explored the problem, there would come a certain place where the Holy Spirit would say, "Now." He would inject the answer, and I would say, "My God, that is what I will do."

The Holy Spirit would take me through the problem for the simple reason that, at the right point, He could get the answer over to me.

I prayed for several months until I entered into that state of rest. Then, instead of fighting with my mind, I found out it would work for me. It could feed the problem through so the Holy Spirit could feed the answer in at the right moment. Every time, it would be the answer.

Let me give you a small example.

My accountant was upset with me. He threw all the bills down and said, "What are you going to do about these bills?"

I had been in the ministry about a year. I said, "I am going to pay them."

He said, "Do you have the money?"

"No, I do not have it in my hand right now, but they are paid by faith."

He said, "I need something more concrete to go on than that."

I said, "I do not have anything more concrete than the Word of God. But they are paid."

In those days I could be disturbed, but I knew what to do about it. I retreated to the closet. I was out in the woods praying, walking, and fighting the care.

A young man from India, Augie David, had come to travel with me. I finally prayed through to that place of peace and came into the house to get ready for a meeting. Then I received a telephone call.

A preacher said, "Is Augie David working for you?"

I said, "Yes."

"He lived with a widow woman in Portland."

"Yes."

"He left her with four hundred dollars of phone bills to India."

I said, "He did?"

He said Augie should be more responsible, and if I was his employer and a minister, I should take responsibility. In the middle of his ranting, the Holy Spirit turned on.

He said to me, "Do you want to know why he is ranting and raving?"

I said, "Why?"

"Because of condemnation. I told him to pay it. If he had said yes, I would have told him what I was going to give him. I was going to bless him with a thousand dollars. But if you will pay it, I will give you the same deal."

I said, "You got it."

I got a check, went into the accountant's office, and cleaned the account out. We had about four hundred and three dollars in there. It did not do any good against the bills, but I mailed it off.

Augie said he had been standing in faith with everything in him. His confession was that it was paid, and that is why he had not told anybody. He was fighting for it as much as he knew how.

I left town the next morning. When my accountant found out, he was hot. To make it worse, I went to meetings in Medford with just a few people in a hall. We had just enough money to pay the hall that week.

The Lord said, "Extend."

I checked, and the hall was available the next week. I went out there and taught everything I knew. Suddenly people started putting hundred-dollar bills in the offering. I counted that week's offering, and it came to twenty-three hundred dollars.

You should have seen Macho Faith walk into the accountant's office.

He said, "What is this?"

I said, "The offering."

He counted it and said, "God really moved, did He not?"

I said, "Yes. Pay the bills. I have a little left over."

The most definite, practical application of the inner witness is this: if you can make it to that place of peace, whenever you go the wrong direction, the peace is disturbed, and you can get back on the right direction.

The thing a man should fight for is entry into that peace, because once you start attaining it, it gets better and better.

Oppression, cares, pressures, and persecutions not only rob you and keep you from the leadership of the Spirit; they make you devourable by the devil. Long-term care and pressure cause breakdowns in attitudes, frail nerves, digestive problems, irregular heartbeats, respiratory problems, and even skin issues.

One of the first things I noticed when I entered into a different place of rest was that the Holy Spirit began to communicate with me. In those first days of extended times praying in the Holy Ghost, my mind began to wake up.

Here is a small testimony. I am not proud of my past, and I am not proud of the attitude I took toward schooling. I dropped out of high school in my senior year, mainly because it interfered with the fun I wanted to have. I had to support my car. I was a slow starter. At eighteen I did not have many goals or much aim.

I joined the Navy, spent three wild years there, and was born again when I was twenty-two. I had been on a ship with the man who is now my brother-in-law. He had been foul-mouthed and vile, but after we both got out of the Navy, he flagged me down on the freeway and finally told me, "I have been born again. I want you to go to church with me in the morning."

I said, "I am on my way to a party. I will have a hangover in the morning. But maybe I will go with you tomorrow night."

That afternoon he came by the house and brought his sister, who is my wife now. When I saw her, I said, "I will go for sure."

I had grown up as a welfare kid. Once in a while neighbors would feel sorry for us and take us to Sunday school, so I had cruised through churches a little. But when I went that Sunday night, it was a Pentecostal holiness revival center where people like Leroy Jenkins' mother and A. A. Allen's team had come through.

I sat down smugly. Dry, dead church had never bothered me. But then people started falling on the floor, miracles were taking place, and I thought, "What is this?" It was not long before the prayer warriors dragged me up, shook me, and said, "Get it! Get it! God gave it to you!"

My wife and I eloped, got married, and came back. During the first six or seven months of our marriage, I prayed through. One day, as I was running around the front room, the power of God came on me. Here I was with no ability, no education, going nowhere.

Grandpa used to get upset and say, "You are going to turn out just like old man Roberson." My father robbed small gas stations and grocery stores and had his own little crime operation. They gave him a choice between prison and the service, and he went into the service during wartime as a truck driver. In 1957 he came to our house when I was in high school, the first time I remembered what he looked like. He drove out of the driveway that day, and that was the last we saw of him.

When I was born again in an ultra-Pentecostal holiness church, I thought, "I lost one father like that, and now these holiness people are preaching to me that this Father is going to beat me and treat me like my natural father did."

My mother ran my father off because she was afraid for our lives. I can still remember hiding my toy airplane under the bed. She had bought it out of grocery money, and she said that if he found it, he would stomp it.

Those childhood memories are hard for me to go back to. I am saying this for a reason.

In that holiness church, I thought, "God, You are going to take everything I have." One preacher preached, "My kids stood between me and the ministry, but when they drowned in our swimming pool, God removed what was between me and the ministry, and I answered the call." That is the kind of preaching we heard.

It was not until I was thirty years old that somebody handed me my first "You Are the Righteousness of God in Christ" tapes. I found out who my Father was, and I found out who I was.

Because I was so hungry for God, He had mercy on me as a holiness boy at thirty years old and gave me a visitation. The power of God was on me, and I saw myself sitting four rows back on the left side of a large auditorium with people in wheelchairs. The man in front was ready to turn the service over to me. I knew it was my service.

He said, "Now our evangelist," and then he spun around and pointed at the curtain. A woman came out and took the service over. After she ministered and emptied the wheelchairs, she looked right at me. The whole crowd disappeared around us, and she said, "I do not know why God has given me this ministry. One of you men must have failed."

I was in uncontrollable weeping. When I came out of it, my wife woke up. I said, "I cannot live this way anymore. Swim, sink, eat beans, sleep under a tree, dress the kids in gunny sacks, pastor the little church, or move into it; anything is better than what I feel on the inside. I hurt. Will you go with me?"

She said, "Yes, I will."

I resigned my job at the mill with three little kids. I was trying to preach at a little church down the street. I had about six members, had nothing, and could not preach.

That was when I locked myself in the prayer closet at 6:30 in the morning and prayed through until the afternoon. I did not know anything about anything. I was just praying in tongues to survive the hours I had locked myself into. I did not know I was working the plan of God in my personal life. How could I know that?

All I was doing was trying to survive the hours I would normally be working, but in that closet the plan of God began to activate.

As part of that plan, a man brought me a box of reel-to-reel Kenneth Hagin tapes. That was when I got turned on to the Word during that prayer-closet time. I would go home at night after praying all day and thread that old reel-to-reel machine. It was on its last leg, and it would croak at a certain spot. I would put the speaker between my head and my wife's head and listen to Hagin teaching.

My wife asked, "Are you married to that speaker, or are you married to me?"

Three months later, when I brought a seven-hundred-and-eighty-six-dollar manifestation into the house, which caught us up on three months of bills and gave us one hundred dollars of sowing money, she said, "You can put two speakers in there if you want."

So I got turned on to the Word and started waking up. The more I prayed in the Holy Ghost, the more the renewing process took place. Some of the attributes of Adam began to wake up. A hunger to know and to learn became so intense inside me that I became ashamed of the years I had wasted.

I found out that something happened to me in the prayer closet so that I did not have to depend on my ability anymore. I could learn to depend on His.

The first thing I began to work on was my language, which I am still working on.

Bernard, who played the piano, is a political science professor who teaches journalism. He was reading one of my letters and asked, "Who taught you how to write?"

I said, "It is the strangest thing, but the Holy Ghost taught me during praying in tongues." Those letters you get, I write them eighteen or nineteen pages on a yellow pad. The only things the office corrects are spelling and little sentence structures, the things I thought were more important to learn in high school.

I told Bernard how the Holy Spirit taught me to create an image with a pencil, so that one image leads to the next and the next until the entire letter is in your understanding.

He said, "Those are the principles we teach in journalism."

I had to hold back tears, because I am so hungry, and to find out that through edification and inner peace my Teacher can teach me anything was overwhelming.

Seven years after answering the ministry, I had two counseling appointments on the same day. I know God did it for me. Both men had gotten hold of our "Meditation, Imagery, and Delivery" series, the one we did for preachers, and wanted counsel from me. I asked both of them separately if we could go to dinner together, and they agreed.

When they introduced themselves to each other, one was a professor of speech and the other was a professor of languages. I thought, "They want to counsel me."

One began talking about the Greek orators and how those men learned to speak with such power, using imagery and mastery of language to move people. He said that some of the principles the Holy Spirit had brought out in that meditation series were things he had never heard before, and they wanted counsel from me.

I sat there squirming until it finally came around: "Where did you receive your education?"

I said, "The Holy Ghost taught me."

They said, "Yes, we know the Holy Ghost is able, but what formal education?"

I finally had to tell them. They said, "Well, we know the Holy Ghost is able." And He is.

That was a highlight. It was a monument to the ability of Jesus Christ when you allow Him who has been sent to reveal Jesus to help your infirmities. Your infirmities must be the things that hold you back, and He helps them. When you do not know how to pray, He puts things into your power plant, the part of you that rules your life.

Listen closely. Once, while driving through Tulsa, I saw a house falling down: peeling paint, broken fence, overgrown lawn, trash everywhere, broken-down cars.

The Lord said to me, "The outside of the house is an exact picture of the inside of the man who lives in it."

I ran home and mowed my lawn.

If your spirit had the ability to produce a photograph, what came out would be an exact picture of everything around your life. The heart is called a treasury for the same reason the U.S. Treasury is called a treasury: it supplies the ability to keep things running.

Your life is a picture. If you change the picture on the inside through meditation, praying in the Holy Ghost, and the Word of God, it will not be long before outward circumstances conform to that picture. But the first picture you would pull out would be a picture of peace.

The Lord asked me, "Do you know the difference between the man who lives in that broken-down house and the man who owns Walmart?"

I said, "Yes, about eight billion dollars."

He said, "The difference between the two is what is working on the inside of them. That is what you can change."

You can use the life He has given you for victory. You can bring revival to a city. Or you can lie around in self-pity and care. You can force yourself to pray in tongues a few hours a day, and even when your flesh screams and you hit impasses, you can say, "Be quiet. Your days are numbered."

You can change it. Even when you do not want to, you can change it. If you let your spirit have its way, you do not have to be a failure. You can succeed where it really counts, in the heavenlies.

Remember when we preached on true exaltation. Jesus said not to invite your rich kinsmen and neighbors to dinner because they can recompense you. Do not give to get. Invite the poor, the maimed, the lame, and the blind. Why? They cannot pay you. God will recompense you at the resurrection of the just.

In other words, do not give out of self-exaltation. Use what God has given you to serve the kingdom, and He will see to it that you are exalted. When you lay treasures up in heaven, He will take care of you here.

It may take a lot of gas to get to the meeting, but He will give you more if you use your time to pray when you get here.

How many of you are going to pray more in the Holy Ghost? How many of you are facing an impasse, some problem you have not been able to solve?

The answer is within. He is in there. He has been sent to help your infirmity, your inability to produce results. He is God.

Meditation will take you on a journey into victory before you get there.